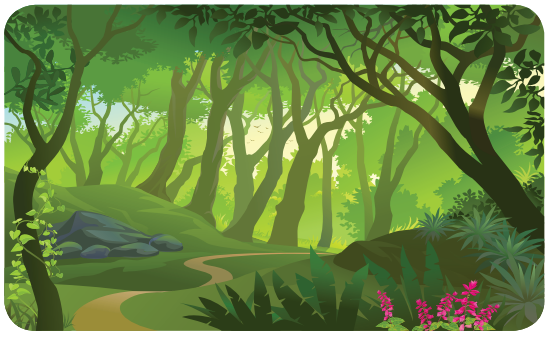
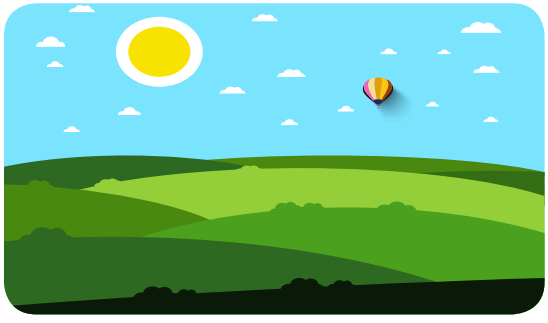
a. Forest habitat

Forest is a large area dominated by trees. There are three types of forests. They are: Tropical forests, Temperate forests and Mountain forests. Annual rain fall here ranges from 25 - 200 cm.



b. Grass land habitat

Grassland is an area where the vegetation is dominated by grasses. Grasses range from short to tall. **Example**: Savanna Grassland



c. Desert habitat

A habitat without much water is called deserts. Deserts are the driest place on earth. They get less than 25cm of rainfall annually. Deserts cover atleast 20% of the Earth. The plants which grow in this habitat have thick leaves that store water and minerals. The plants like cactus store water in their stem and the leaves are reduced to spines. They have long roots that go very deep in the soil in search of water. Types of desert habitat include:

(i) Hot dry deserts

(ii) Semi arid deserts

(iii) Coastal deserts

(iv) Cold deserts.

Example: Cactus, Agave, Aloe, Bryophyllum



Fact file

Thar Desert, also called Great Indian Desert, is an arid region of rolling sand hills on the Indian subcontinent. It is located partly in Rajasthan state, north-western India, and partly in Punjab and Sindh (Sind) provinces, Eastern Pakistan.

Activity 5

Visit a nearby nursery. Choose any ten varieties of plants and place them under the appropriate habitats.

DO YOU KNOW?

World habitat day is observed on 1st Monday of October every year.

4.3 Plant Adaptations and Modifications

Adaptations are special features in plants which help them to survive in the habitats they live over a long period. Plants in a specific environment have developed special features which help them to grow and live in that particular habitat. In this section, Let us study about some adaptations like tendrils, twiners and thorns.